Ian Callen

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

Economics of education, K-12 education policy, inequality in education, labor markets

EDUCATION

University of Virginia — Charlottesville, VA
Ph.D., Education Policy — *expected: 2028*

Montana State University — Bozeman, MT
M.S., Applied Economics — 2022

Western Washington University — Bellingham, WA
B.S., Statistics — 2020
B.A., Economics

EMPLOYMENT

Montana State University
Instructor of Economics — 2022 – 2025

American Institutes for Research, CALDER Center
Research Associate — 2022 – 2025

PUBLICATIONS

Callen, I., Carbonari, M. V., DeArmond, M., Dewey, D., Dizon-Ross, E., Goldhaber, D., Isaacs, J., Kane, T. J., Kuhfeld, M., McDonald, A., McEachin, A., Morton, E., Muroga, A., & Staiger, D. O. (2025). Summer School as a Learning Loss Recovery Strategy after COVID-19: Evidence from Summer 2022. *American Educational Research Journal*. [link]

Callen, I., Goldhaber, D., & Morton, E. (2025). Evidence on the large negative and heterogenous effects of the pandemic on student achievement. *Handbook on Inequality and COVID-19*, 254-277. [link]

Callen, I., & Stoddard, C. (2024). Putting the "A" in AP: The effect of advanced placement state policies on student participation and performance. *Economics of Education Review*, 102, 102565. [link]

WORKING PAPERS

Callen, I., Dizon-Ross, E., Goldhaber, D., Kane, T., McEachin, A., & Morton, E. (2026). A Broader View of Recovery: Exploring Non-Test Student Outcomes in the Wake of the COVID-19 Pandemic. CALDER Working Paper No. 344-0826. [link]

Callen, I., & Stoddard, C. (2025). Advanced Placement Access and College Enrollment: Postsecondary Effects of Advanced Placement State Policies. [link]
Invited revise and resubmit at Education Finance and Policy.

Callen, I., Goldhaber, D., Kane, T. J., McDonald, A., McEachin, A., & Morton, E. (2024). Pandemic Learning Loss by Student Baseline Achievement: Extent and Sources of Heterogeneity. CALDER Working Paper No. 292-0224. [link]
Invited revise and resubmit at Economics of Education Review.

WORKS IN PROGRESS

Interest in Teaching: Motivations, Self-Perceptions, and the Decline in Interest.
with Brendan Bartanen and John Krieg.

Why Are Recession-Era Teachers More Effective? Evidence on Selection into Teaching from Texas.

Why Does Teacher Performance Drift? Context-Dependence in the Stability of Teacher Effectiveness
with Brendan Bartanen and Andrew Avitabile.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor
Montana State University
Courses:
ECNS 101 – Economic Way of Thinking (Fall 2023; Fall 2024)
ECNS 202 – Macroeconomics (Summer 2023; Summer 2025)
ECNS 206 – Microeconomics (Spring 2023; Spring 2024)
ECNS 309 – Managerial Economics (Fall 2022)

Teaching Assistant
Montana State University
Courses:
ECNS 101 – Economic Way of Thinking (Fall 2020; Spring 2021; Fall 2021; Spring 2022)
ECNS 202 – Macroeconomics (Fall 2020; Spring 2021)

TALKS AND TUTORIALS

2026: EdPolicyWorks (UVA), Association for Education Finance and Policy (AEFP), Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM)
2025: EdPolicyWorks (UVA), AEFP, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign
2024: EdPolicyWorks (UVA), AEFP, APPAM, CALDER/CEDR Research Meeting, CALDER RA Seminar, Wake County Public School System
2023: CALDER RA Seminar
2022: AEFP, Graduate Research Seminar (MSU – Bozeman), Dept of Ag. Econ & Econ Brown Bag (MSU – Bozeman)
2021: Western Washington Data-Driven Discovery Seminar Series (WWU/PNNL), Graduate Student Research Seminar (MSU – Bozeman)

AWARDS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND GRANTS

Awards and fellowships:
– Emerging Education Policy Scholars (EEPS), Cohort 15, American Enterprise Institute & Thomas B. Fordham Institute, 2027
– Graduate Research Fellowship, American Institutes for Boys and Men, 2026-2028
– University of Virginia Presidential Fellowship, 2024-2028

– Finalist, College of Letters and Science Three Minute Thesis (3MT) Competition, Montana State University, 2022

Grants:

– Graduate Student Travel Grant (EDLF), University of Virginia, 2026

– Faculty Sponsor, Initiative for Regulation and Applied Economic Analysis, Montana State University, 2023, $3,000

– College of Letters and Science Dean's Student Travel Fund, Montana State University, 2022, $1,000

OUTREACH AND SERVICE

Ad-Hoc Reviewer: *Education Finance and Policy, Educational Evaluation and Policy Analysis, Journal of Teacher Education, Teachers College Record*

Conference Reviewer: *Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM), Society for Research on Educational Effectiveness (SREE), Hunter Student Research Conference (HSRC)*

Seminar Organizer: Graduate Research Seminar at Montana State University (2021-2022), RAW Stats Research Group (2019-2020)